

Page 1 of 6 · Three Shiny Apples

Panda-Cake opens the bakery pantry and finds the picnic list tucked inside an empty basket. The first picture shows apples. Corgi-on-the-Cob rolls them gently across the counter while Panda-Cake catches each one before it reaches the flour bin.



Page 2 of 6 · The Berry Tables

At the market, two berry tables stand side by side. One farmer has a small bowl left; the other has a fuller bowl. Panda-Cake needs the bowl with more berries, but only if there will still be enough for the farmer’s family.



Page 3 of 6 · Numbered Bread Baskets

Four bread baskets wait beside the oven, but one number card has slipped beneath a tea towel. Corgi lifts the corner while Panda-Cake reads the basket numbers in order. Sequence: 2, 3, ?, 5



Page 4 of 6 · Two Neat Rows

Panda-Cake arranges picnic buns in two neat rows. Five sit on the blue cloth and five sit on the yellow cloth. Corgi guards both rows very seriously, although one crumb lands on his nose.



Page 5 of 6 · Room in the Basket

The list is complete, but a tiny jar of honey still waits on the counter. Panda-Cake looks at the packed basket and notices one open corner. Careful arranging can make space without squashing a single bun.



Page 6 of 6 · A Picnic to Share

At the meadow, Panda-Cake places every treat on the long cloth. Friends arrive in twos and threes until twelve happy picnic places are filled. Panda-Cake checks the basket one last time. There is enough because everyone planned and counted together.

Questions for Panda-Cake’s Market Basket

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · Three Shiny Apples

How many apples belong in the basket?

Choices: 2 · 3 · 4

Page 2 · The Berry Tables

Which group has more?

Choices: 4 berries · 6 berries · They match

Page 3 · Numbered Bread Baskets

Which number belongs in the gap?

Sequence: 2, 3, ?, 5 Choices: 2 · 4 · 6

Page 4 · Two Neat Rows

Five buns and five more make how many?

Choices: 8 · 10 · 12

Page 5 · Room in the Basket

How many open spaces are left for the honey?

Choices: 0 · 1 · 2

Page 6 · A Picnic to Share

Which number is two more than 10?

Choices: 11 · 12 · 13

After reading

How did Panda-Cake fit the honey jar into a full basket?

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 3. Three shiny apples settle at the bottom of the basket.

Page 2: 6 berries. Six berries are more than four, and the farmer has another basket to share.

Page 3: 4. Four completes the row, and the warm rolls are ready to pack.

Page 4: 10. Two groups of five make ten picnic buns.

Page 5: 1. One open space is exactly enough for the honey jar.

Page 6: 12. Twelve places are ready for twelve hungry friends.

After reading: By looking carefully, Panda-Cake found the one open corner and arranged everything so the jar fitted without squashing a single bun.

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